Is Your Dog Talking to You?

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: Animals and pets
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 4 · after the lesson you can read about animals and talk about how they behave



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

It is six o'clock in the morning in a small **village**. The sun is coming up. Nobody is awake, but the dogs are. One dog barks. Another dog answers. Soon ten dogs are talking at the same time. Are they just making noise? No. They are saying something, and we only need to learn how to listen.

Dogs and people are old friends. More than 15,000 years ago, wolves came close to human camps because they wanted food. People gave them some, and the wolves stayed. Slowly, they became dogs. Scientists think there are about 900 million dogs in the world today. People tell them secrets, take them for walks and sleep next to them. Yet we **frequently** forget to listen to them.

Take the tail. Most people think a wagging tail means "I'm happy", but it is more complicated. Some studies suggest that a wag to the right shows a dog feels **positive**, while a wag to the left can mean it is nervous. A dog that stands **calm** with a slow wag is **content**; a dog with a stiff, high tail is saying "keep away". So the golden rule is simple: **avoid** a dog that stares at you, and never run. To a dog, running is a game, and it will **expect** you to play.

Here is a simple test. Look at the whole dog, not only the tail. Are the ears up? Is the mouth open? Is the dog jumping? Then it is probably happy. Is the dog looking away, or is it making itself small? Then it is probably afraid. Give it some space.

Dogs are also smarter than we think. An average dog understands about 150 words, and a border collie called Chaser learned the names of more than 1,000 toys. But a dog cannot read your mind. When it **behaves** badly, it is rarely "bad": maybe it is bored, scared or simply young. That is why trainers say: be **patient**, **instruct** the dog clearly and do not **punish** it. A dog does not connect a shout with something it did an hour ago. And it is not **appropriate** to hug a strange dog: experts say many dogs find hugs stressful.

Is Your Dog Talking to You?

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

Then there is the nose. A human has about six million scent cells; a dog has about 300 million. That is why a dog can find one tiny crumb under the sofa while you are still looking for your phone. It also explains the dog's **habit** of stopping every two meters on a **stroll**. Don't be angry: for a dog, a walk is not exercise, it is reading the news. Every lamp post is a newspaper.

Here are five quick facts. One: puppies sleep about 18 hours a day. Two: dogs dream, like people. Three: a greyhound can run 70 kilometers an hour. Four: the Basenji, a dog from Africa, almost never barks. It makes a sound like singing. Five: Dalmatian puppies are white at birth, and the black spots come later.

Of course, some people have a real **concern**. Some street dogs bite, and in big cities this is a serious **issue**. But experts say that **none** of these dogs starts life dangerous: they learn it from bad experiences. Animal charities **represent** the dogs in a way: they speak for animals that cannot speak, and they ask the government for better rules. More and more people adopt a street dog, and this idea is **spreading** around the world.

Hachiko was an Akita dog in Tokyo. Every day he went with his owner, Professor Ueno, to the station, and every evening he waited for him there. One day in 1925 the professor died at work and did not come home. Hachiko did not understand. He went back to the station every day for almost ten years. People brought him food, and today there is a statue of Hachiko outside the station.

So watch your dog today. Look at its tail, its ears and its eyes. Talk to it in a friendly voice, and be **patient**. When your dog tilts its head and **shakes** its ears, don't laugh. It is trying very hard to understand you. And it answers, with its whole body.

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: Animals and pets

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 4, pages 26–29. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
appropriate adj.	right for the situation	подходящий, уместный	Jeans are not appropriate for a wedding.
avoid v.	stay away from; not do	избегать	Avoid big dogs you don't know.
behave v.	act in a certain way	вести себя	The children behave well in class.
calm adj.	quiet, not nervous	спокойный	Stay calm and breathe slowly.
concern n./v.	a worry; to worry	беспокойство; беспокоить	My mom's main concern is my health.
content adj.	happy and satisfied	довольный	The cat is content after its dinner.
expect v.	think something will happen	ожидать	I expect a good grade this time.
frequently adv.	often	часто	He frequently forgets his keys.
habit n.	something you do again and again	привычка	Brushing your teeth is a good habit.
instruct v.	tell someone how to do something	инструктировать, указывать	The coach instructs the players.
issue n.	an important topic or problem	вопрос, проблема	Plastic in the sea is a big issue.
none pron.	not one, not any	ни один, никто	None of my friends came.
patient adj.	able to wait without getting angry	терпеливый	Be patient: the bus is coming.
positive adj.	good, hopeful	позитивный, уверенный	Stay positive, you can do it!
punish v.	make someone suffer for a mistake	наказывать	The teacher didn't punish him.
represent v.	speak or act for a group	представлять	She represents our school at the Olympiad.
shake v.	move quickly up and down or side to side	трясти(сь)	The wet dog shook its body.
spread v.	reach more and more people or places	распространять(ся)	News spreads fast online.
stroll v./n.	walk slowly for pleasure	прогуливаться; прогулка	We strolled in the park after dinner.
village n.	a very small town in the country	деревня, кишлак	My grandparents live in a village.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: Animals and pets · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

behave well / badly	вести себя хорошо / плохо
stay calm · keep calm	сохранять спокойствие
break a bad habit	избавиться от вредной привычки
raise an issue · a serious issue	поднять вопрос · серьёзная проблема
a positive attitude	позитивный настрой
express concern	выразить беспокойство
spread the news · spread fast	распространять новость · быстро распространяться
go for a stroll	пойти прогуляться
avoid doing something	избегать (делать что-то)
expect to · expect someone to	ожидать · ждать от кого-то
punish someone for…	наказать за…
appropriate for	подходящий для

Phrasal verbs about people and animals

calm down	успокоиться	Breathe slowly and calm down.
look after	присматривать, заботиться	Can you look after my dog this weekend?
get along with	ладить с	My dog gets along with everybody.
run away	убежать	The puppy was scared and ran away.
tell off	отчитать	The teacher told us off for being late.
bring up	воспитывать	My grandparents brought me up.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

wag	вилять (хвостом)	**stray**	бездомный
bark	лаять	**loyal**	верный, преданный
growl	рычать	**paw**	лапа
bite	кусать	**tail**	хвост
lead / leash	поводок	**sniff**	нюхать

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words
This week: **Book 1, Unit 4, “The Dog’s Bell”**, pages 26–31. Next: **Unit 5, “The Jackal and the Sun Child”**, pages 32–37. More animals: **Unit 1, “The Lion and the Rabbit”**, pages 8–13.